AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Nedbank Foundation / Nedbank Corporate Social Investment × ASCO

Community Green Action and Resilience Hubs

Requested CSI investment: R150,000

Proposed implementation area: A South African rural or semi-urban community to be selected after ASCO's documented needs assessment, with preference for a site where Nedbank's green-economy priorities (waste/recycling, water, regenerative food production or environmental restoration) and local authority/community permissions can be demonstrated.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Nedbank Foundation / Nedbank Corporate Social Investment** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Community Green Action and Resilience Hubs**. The proposed request is **R150,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Community Green Action and Resilience Hubs in A South African rural or semi-urban community to be selected after ASCO's documented needs assessment, with preference for a site where Nedbank's green-economy priorities (waste/recycling, water, regenerative food production or environmental restoration) and local authority/community permissions can be demonstrated., benefiting Proposed: approximately 150-250 directly participating residents, prioritising youth, women and people with disabilities, plus surrounding households and community institutions benefiting indirectly; final numbers and demographic profile to be established by baseline assessment. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Nedbank Foundation / Nedbank Corporate Social Investment's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R150,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Community Green Action and Resilience Hubs

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
A South African rural or semi-urban community to be selected after ASCO's documented needs assessment, with preference for a site where Nedbank's green-economy priorities (waste/recycling, water, regenerative food production or environmental restoration) and local authority/community permissions can be demonstrated.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: approximately 150-250 directly participating residents, prioritising youth, women and people with disabilities, plus surrounding households and community institutions benefiting indirectly; final numbers and demographic profile to be established by baseline assessment.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: complete one participatory baseline, site risk assessment and implementation plan before field activity begins.
- Proposed: establish or restore one community environmental-action site and complete at least 4 documented action days during the grant period.
- Proposed: train at least 40 local participants in environmental stewardship, waste separation/recycling, water conservation and/or regenerative food practices, with attendance and pre/post knowledge records.
- Proposed: divert or responsibly process at least 2,000 kg of recoverable waste, or use an alternative verified environmental metric agreed at inception.
- Proposed: plant and maintain at least 500 locally appropriate trees or food-producing plants, subject to ecological and landowner approval, with a 6-month survival/maintenance check.
- Proposed: produce quarterly activity, expenditure and outcome reports, a beneficiary register, photographic/geotagged evidence where appropriate, and a final impact report against agreed indicators.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Nedbank Foundation / Nedbank Corporate Social Investment?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- Nedbank's official Sustainable Development Framework says sustainable development finance, support for the transition to a net-zero economy and financial inclusion are core focus areas, enabled in part by CSI.
- Nedbank's 2024 Society Report describes its Green Economy Strategy as focusing on renewable energy, regenerative agriculture, waste and recycling, and water and sanitation; it emphasises sustainable livelihoods and scalable economic ecosystems, especially for women, youth and people with disabilities in rural and semi-urban areas.
- The 2024 Society Report reports CSI spend categories including green economy and community development, but does not establish that a particular grant is available to ASCO or that the Foundation has committed to this proposal.
- Nedbank's May 2025 official announcement describes a South Africa-focused Green Economy Social Impact Strategy addressing agriculture, energy, water and waste, with measurable environmental and social impact, skills and job creation as stated objectives.
- The official CSI funding form requests organisational details including PBO/NPO information, project description and rationale, quantified objectives and timelines, monitoring and evaluation, risks, beneficiary demographics, detailed budget, other donors and supporting records.
- The available official funding form is dated November 2015; a current, publicly confirmed Foundation application window or eligibility policy was not verified.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R90,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R12,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R9,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R12,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R10,500	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R10,500	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R6,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R150,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R150,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

No current official Nedbank Foundation application/contact route was verified. The only directly located official route is the Nedbank CSI Funding Application Form (November 2015): https://nedbank.co.za/content/dam/nedbank/site-assets/AboutUs/CSI/Supporting_Documents/Nedbank%20CSI%20Funding%20Application%20Form%20November%202015.pdf. ASCO should confirm a current route and eligibility with Nedbank through an official Nedbank corporate contact channel before relying on this form; ASCO's supplied contact is +27 76 757 5773 and https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- ASCO's exact municipality, community baseline, land/access permissions and implementation partners are not supplied; location should therefore be confirmed through a needs and feasibility assessment before submission.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- The current funding cycle, eligible applicant classes, maximum grant, geographic restrictions, restricted costs and decision timeline were not found in a current official source.
- The 2015 form requests extensive attachments, including audited financial statements, annual report, budget, project budget, reference letter, registration certificates, constitution, donor contacts and quotations; confirm whether these requirements remain current.
- No completed ASCO results, existing Nedbank partnership, Foundation commitment or guaranteed funding should be claimed.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Nedbank Foundation / Nedbank Corporate Social Investment** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://group.nedbank.co.za/sustainability/sustainability-development.html
2. https://group.nedbank.co.za/content/dam/group/pdf/21_integrated-reports/2024/sustainability-reporting/2024-society-report-nedbank.pdf
3. https://group.nedbank.co.za/news-and-insights/press/2025/nedbank-partnership-with-further-impact-launches-the-greenhouse.html
4. https://nedbank.co.za/content/dam/nedbank/site-assets/AboutUs/CSI/Supporting_Documents/Nedbank%20CSI%20Funding%20Application%20Form%20November%202015.pdf

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.